

Teaching Notes, **Part 4: Unit III**, The Sources of Theology (Lectures 11 to 16)

Morning Star Regional Seminary, Barrackpore.

These are your notes. Each lecture gives the opening problem, the teaching content, the references, the cross-references to the rest of the course, the illustrations for the board, and a teaching tip with the reading and the reflection prompt.

THE ARC OF UNIT III

Unit III answers the fourth of the six goals, who has authority in theology, and it carries the first precept of Bernard Lonergan, be attentive. Having said in Unit II what theology is, the student now asks the next honest question: where does theology get its content, and who may say what is true? The unit does its work in six steps that build on one another. Lecture 11 shows that the long shelf of theologians is not a quarrel to be feared but the natural fruit of finite minds meeting an infinite mystery, one Lord spoken in many tongues, with philosophy as the old partner of faith. Lecture 12 takes up Scripture, the norm that norms all and is normed by none, the soul of theology, and gives the Catholic answer to the slogan *sola scriptura*. Lecture 13 takes up Tradition, the living handing-on of the whole faith, the faith of the dead kept alive by the Spirit, which develops without changing its identity. Lecture 14 takes up the teaching office of the Church, servant and not master of the Word, together with the *sensus fidelium*, the faith-sense of the whole people. Lecture 15 adds reason and experience, and above all the cry of the poor, as true sources under the Word. Lecture 16 gathers the whole into one, showing how the Second Vatican Council re-mapped the sources: one wellspring, two streams, one table, served by one office under one Spirit.

The thread that runs through all six is attentiveness. A source can be received only by a theologian who has first learned to attend: to the text as it stands, before he forces his own meaning on it; to the living memory of the Church, and not only to the printed page; to the voice of the teaching office; to the consent of the faithful; to honest reason; and to the cry that rises from the poor of this land. The sin against this whole unit is inattention, the theologian who does not look. Keep the precept be attentive on the board for these six days, beside the six questions, and ask at the end of each class what the day asked the student to attend to.

LECTURE 11: Why are there hundreds of theologians if truth is one?

The opening problem. Walk the students, in their minds, into the seminary library and stand them before the long shelves: Augustine and Aquinas, Rahner and Ratzinger, Gutiérrez and Amaladoss, hundreds of names, many of them disagreeing with one another.

Then put the question. If God is one, and the truth is one, why this crowd of competing voices? Two fears stand behind the question, and most students hold one or the other. The pious student fears that, since truth is one, most of that shelf must be error, and the library is half full of near-heretics. The modern student fears the opposite, that since the voices differ, theology must be mere opinion, and none of it is real knowledge. Hold both fears in the room, and then turn them. Plurality in theology is neither heresy nor relativism. It is the natural fruit of finite minds meeting an infinite mystery, from many times, places, and peoples. The long shelf is not a quarrel to be silenced; it is a communion to be received.

The teaching content. Begin where the students have already been, for plurality is not a late accident but is built into theology from the first page. Recall Lecture 6. The one Christ-event gave rise to many readings already inside the New Testament: the Word made flesh in John, the Messiah of the Synoptics, the cosmic Christ of Colossians, the great High Priest of Hebrews. This was not confusion but the natural fruit of one community reflecting from many angles on one inexhaustible mystery. What was true of the New Testament is true of the whole tradition that follows it: one Lord, and many theologies.

Now give them the principle underneath, which the tradition calls the one and the many. God is one and infinite; the human mind is finite, and human minds are many. No single mind, and no single age, can hold the whole. So many true and partial accounts arise, each lit from a different angle, each catching something the others have missed. This is not relativism, and the students must learn to tell the difference sharply. Relativism says there are many truths and no way to choose among them. The Catholic sense of plurality says something else entirely: there is one Truth, spoken in many ways, and the many ways are answerable to the one Truth and to one another, so that they correct and complete each other rather than cancel each other out. Difference is not contradiction. This is one of the seven polarities of theology that the course teaches, the one and the many, first touched in Lecture 9 and named formally in Unit V.

India has carried this insight for three thousand years, and the Indian student should hear that his own soil prepared him to understand it. The Rig Veda says: *ekam sat viprah bahudha vadanti*, "Truth is one; the wise speak of it in many ways" (Rig Veda I.164.46). Teach this verse with care, because the careless reading turns it into relativism. The verse does not say that there are many truths; it says that the one Truth is named manifold. That is exactly the catholic instinct: one faith, many theologies; one Lord, many tongues. The seminarian of Bengal is not betraying the oneness of God when he welcomes many ways of speaking of him; he is being faithful to a God too great for any single tongue.

There is a further reason the shelf is so long, and it is worth naming, because it is the chief honest source of plurality. Theology has always thought with the help of philosophy. Faith seeks understanding, and to understand itself it borrows the tools of human reason. The Greek Fathers thought with Plato and the Stoics; Thomas Aquinas thought with Aristotle; the moderns thought with the personalists and the phenomenologists; Indian theology thinks with the *darshanas*, with Vedanta, and with the categories of this land. Aquinas called philosophy the handmaid of theology, *ancilla theologiae*, the servant who carries the water for the mistress of the house, not because faith needs philosophy to stand, but

because reason makes the teaching of faith clearer (Summa Theologiae Ia, q.1, a.5). A different philosophy in the hand yields a different theology on the page, and this is not error but the working of one faith through many minds. Give the students the image that John Paul II made famous: faith and reason are the two wings on which the human spirit rises toward the truth. Philosophy, purified, serves faith; faith heals and lifts reason; and the marriage of the two, made differently in different ages, is one steady reason that the library is full.

Close the lecture by drawing the banks, lest the student now swing into thinking that anything goes. Plurality is not boundless. Recall Lecture 10. Theology has banks, and on the far side of them lies heresy, which is not plurality but its corruption, the choosing of one part against the whole. The skill the student is beginning to learn, and will keep learning all his life, is to tell legitimate plurality, the schools, the contexts, the methods, the many true windows, from real contradiction, the denial of what the Church believes. A school differs from another school in stress and in method; a heresy denies the faith itself. Plurality is the health of a living tradition. The fear of all plurality is itself a kind of sickness, for it would freeze the one faith into one tongue and silence the Spirit who speaks in many.

Illustration. Two images for the board, both from this land. The first is the old story of the blind men and the elephant. Several blind men touch one elephant, and each describes a different beast: the man at the leg says a pillar, the man at the ear says a winnowing fan, the man at the tail says a rope, and they fall to quarrelling. The usual telling makes everyone wrong and concludes that no one can know the truth at all. Give the students the correction, for it is the heart of the lecture. There is a real elephant. The blind men are not wrong, only partial. And there is a mahout, the keeper, who has walked with the whole animal and holds the accounts of all the parts together. The Church is not one more blind man guessing; she has met the elephant alive, she has walked with the risen Lord, and in her Tradition she keeps the whole that the partial views serve. So the parable, rightly corrected, teaches both truths at once: that every single theology is partial, and that there is a living whole, kept in the communion of the Church, to which all the partial views are answerable.

The second image is gentler. Take a single poem of Rabindranath Tagore and set beside it its renderings in Bengali, in Hindi, in Santali, and in English. Each translation catches a music that the others miss; none of them is the whole poem; and yet no translation contradicts the poem, because all of them serve the one original. Theology is the translation of the one Word of God into the tongues and the minds of every age and people. The translations are many because the peoples are many; the original is one. Indian theology is one more faithful translation, and a Church that possessed only a single translation would be a poorer house, not a purer one.

References. Neil Ormerod, *Introducing Contemporary Theologies*, Chapter 2, pages 15 to 26, for philosophy and theology in conversation and for the question of plurality. Rig Veda I.164.46, for *ekam sat viprah bahudha vadanti*, the one Truth named in many ways. Thomas Aquinas, *Summa Theologiae* Ia, q.1, a.5, for philosophy as the handmaid of theology, *ancilla theologiae*. John Paul II, *Fides et Ratio*, the opening, for faith and reason as the two wings of the human spirit. For the plurality already present within the New Testament, Raymond E.

Brown, "Christology," in the *New Jerome Biblical Commentary*, and Roger Haight, *Jesus Symbol of God*, as cited in Lecture 6.

Cross-references. The plurality of the New Testament, met in Lecture 6, returns here as the pattern of the whole tradition. The one and the many is one of the seven polarities of theology, first touched in Lecture 9 and named formally in Unit V, Lectures 23 to 29, where the six models of Bevens show that plurality of method is health and not chaos. The banks that keep plurality from collapsing into heresy were drawn in Lecture 10. Philosophy as the partner of theology returns in Lecture 19, the Scholastic age, and in Lecture 27, where Indian theology thinks with the *darshanas*. The library hunt to find five Indian theologians pays its first dividend here, for the student begins to see the long shelf as a communion and not a quarrel. The precept be attentive begins its work: to receive many sources rightly, the theologian must first attend to each without forcing them all into one tongue.

For the professor. Speak first to the student who fears that plurality insults the oneness of God. Tell him that the word *catholic* means "according to the whole," and that a Church able to speak in only one way would be less catholic, not more. Then speak to the student who hears plurality and thinks at once of relativism. Show him that the elephant has a mahout, that the many windows are set in one cathedral, that difference is answerable to the one Truth. The danger to guard against is not the long shelf but the closed mind that absolutises its own corner, for that is the first step on the road to heresy. Reading: Ormerod, Chapter 2, pages 15 to 26. Reflection prompt: "A theologian whose way of speaking is very different from mine, and whom I nonetheless trust, is... because..."

LECTURE 12: Is the Bible enough?

The opening problem. Many of the students have Protestant or Pentecostal friends, and in Bengal the question comes up at the bus stand and over tea: "We have the Bible. Why do you Catholics add Tradition and the Pope? Is the Bible not enough?" The slogan is *sola scriptura*, Scripture alone. Pose it without any scorn, for it springs from a real love of the Word of God. Then turn it gently. The Catholic does not love the Bible less than the one who says "Scripture alone." The Catholic loves it so much that he takes seriously what kind of book it actually is: a book born within the believing community, gathered by that community, and read within it. The right answer is not "the Bible, and then some other things added on top." The right answer is: the one Word of God, written in Scripture, carried within the living Tradition, and served by the teaching office of the Church.

The teaching content. Begin by lifting the dignity of Scripture higher than the bearer of the slogan expects, so that no student ever imagines the Catholic is lukewarm about the Bible. The Second Vatican Council teaches that the Church has always venerated the divine Scriptures as she venerates the Body of the Lord (*Dei Verbum* 21); that the Scriptures are the speech of God as it is set down in writing under the breath of the Holy Spirit (*Dei Verbum* 9); and that the study of the sacred page is the very soul of sacred theology (*Dei Verbum* 24). A Catholic, then, holds the Bible as the inspired written Word of God, without error in what it affirms for the sake of our salvation, and the perpetual foundation of all

theology. We venerate it next to the Eucharist itself. The student must carry this from the first minute: to be Catholic is to love the Bible greatly.

Now the precise Catholic claim. Scripture is the norm that norms and is not normed, *norma normans non normata*. It is the highest written norm, against which every theology, every council, and every act of the teaching office is measured, and which is itself measured by nothing higher in writing. So the Catholic agrees with much of what the Reformers wished to protect: the supremacy of the Word of God over every merely human authority in the Church. No bishop, no council, no Pope stands above Scripture; all of them stand under it and serve it. That is the truth inside *sola scriptura*, and the Church keeps it.

Here, though, the Catholic parts from the slogan, and the parting is where the lecture earns its keep. The Bible did not fall from heaven bound in leather. It was born within the believing community. Press three facts on the students. First, the Church is older than the New Testament. The apostles preached, baptised, broke bread, and lived the faith for years before a single Gospel was written, and the Church was already the Church when Paul wrote his first letter. The living faith came first; the writing followed. Second, the Church discerned the canon, and this is the question that lands hardest, so put it to them plainly: "Who told you that these seventy-three books are the Bible, and not sixty, or eighty? The Bible itself carries no inspired table of contents." It was the believing community, under the guidance of the Spirit, across the first centuries, that recognised which books are inspired and gathered them into one canon (Catechism of the Catholic Church 120). The very table of contents of the Bible is a gift of Tradition. Third, the written Word needs a living reader. Left to private reading alone, it fractures, and the visible proof is the thousands of communities that each claim "Scripture alone" and yet contradict one another about baptism, the Lord's Supper, ministry, and morals. A norm that every person interprets privately ceases to function as a shared norm at all.

Scripture itself warns against unguided private reading. The Second Letter of Peter says that, in the letters of Paul, there are matters hard to understand, which the untaught and unstable distort to their own ruin, as they distort the rest of Scripture (2 Peter 3:16). And in the Acts of the Apostles, when Philip asks the Ethiopian official whether he understands what he is reading, the man answers, "How can I, unless someone guides me?" (Acts 8:30 to 31). Scripture is given to be read within a guiding community, not alone on the road. The water you draw is from a well you did not dig; others have laboured, and you have entered into their labour (John 4:38).

So state the careful Catholic position and have the students write it down. Scripture is materially sufficient, in the sense that it contains, in some manner, all that is needed for our salvation; but it is not formally sufficient, for it does not establish its own canon, settle its own disputed meanings, or apply itself to new questions. It is the inspired written Word, set within and read through the living Tradition, and served by the teaching office that guards it. This is not "the Bible plus two rival authorities standing beside it." Anticipate Lecture 16: Scripture and Tradition are not two separate quarries but two streams from one wellspring (*Dei Verbum* 9), and the teaching office is the servant of both. The Catholic answer to "Is

the Bible enough?" is therefore this: the Bible is the soul of theology and the highest written norm, and precisely because it is a book of the Church, it is rightly read within the Church.

Illustration. The first image is the ancestral land deed. A family holds its ancestral land by a written deed, old and authoritative, the charter of all its rights, and no one in the family stands above the deed. But the deed is read and worked within the living family that has farmed the land for generations and knows where the old boundary stones lie, which corner floods in the monsoon, which well never fails. A stranger who finds the deed in the bazaar and reads it alone, with no family and no knowledge of the land, will mistake its meaning and may even claim the wrong field. Scripture is the deed of the family of God, supreme and binding; and it is read rightly within the family that has lived the land of faith for two thousand years. The deed norms the family, and the family knows how to read the deed.

The second image is the book with no table of contents. Imagine a man handed a thick book whose title page and contents page have been torn out, its chapters loose and shuffled, and told, "Everything you need is in here." He holds the truth in his hands, and still he cannot find his way through it; he does not even know which loose pages truly belong and which were slipped in by a stranger. Someone had to bind the book, set the pages in order, and write the table of contents. The Church is the one who, under the Spirit, bound the seventy-three books, set them in their order, and handed the ordered Bible to her children. To ask for "the Bible alone, without the Church" is to ask for the book while refusing the very hand that bound it.

References. *Dei Verbum*, Chapter 3, sections 11 to 13, for the inspiration of Scripture and for its right interpretation; and, from the same Constitution, *Dei Verbum* 9, for Scripture and Tradition flowing from one wellspring, *Dei Verbum* 21, for the veneration of the Scriptures next to the Body of the Lord, and *Dei Verbum* 24, for Scripture as the soul of sacred theology. The Manual, pages 9 to 11, for the place of Scripture among the sources. 2 Peter 3:16, Acts 8:30 to 31, and John 4:38, in the Revised Standard Version, Catholic Edition. Catechism of the Catholic Church 120, for the discernment of the canon of seventy-three books, and Catechism 80 to 82, for Scripture and Tradition as one sacred deposit. The term *norma normans non normata*, for Scripture as the norm that norms and is not normed.

Cross-references. Scripture as the first and chief source rests on the account of revelation in Lecture 3 and on the New Testament as the earliest theology in Lecture 6. The biblical mark of authentic theology was set in Lecture 10, where *sola scriptura* was first named. Tradition, the partner of Scripture, is the matter of the next lecture, Lecture 13; the teaching office that serves both is Lecture 14; and the re-mapping that binds them into one wellspring is Lecture 16. Scripture as the soul of theology returns in Unit V, where every method begins by attending to the text. The precept be attentive is here at its first and plainest: to attend to Scripture as it stands, before bending it to one's own meaning, is the opening discipline of the theologian.

For the professor. Be irenic about the Protestant and Pentecostal friends of the students, for the Catholic position is not anti-Bible but, if anything, more biblical, since it takes seriously that the Bible is a book of the Church from cover to cover, including its cover. The question about the table of contents is the one that lands hardest; let it sit in silence before you

answer it, for many of these men have never once asked who gave them the very list of books they call the Bible. Send them to the parish with this lecture, since most of their people will meet the slogan "the Bible alone" within the week. Reading: *Dei Verbum*, Chapter 3, sections 11 to 13; the Manual, pages 9 to 11. Reflection prompt: "When a friend says the Bible alone is enough, the one thing I would now want to tell him is..."

LECTURE 13: Can the dead vote?

The opening problem. We live now, in this century, with our own questions. Why should men and women long dead have any vote in what we believe and how we pray? Is Tradition not simply the dead hand of the past laid heavy on the living, the enemy of every reform? The modern instinct, in the Church as much as in the world, is that the past binds us unjustly, and that progress means shaking it off. Pose this honestly, for it is felt by every young man who has ever chafed against an old rule. Then turn it. The question rests on a confusion: between Tradition, the living handing-on of the whole faith, and traditions, the customs that come and go. The dead do vote, and not because the past is sacred in itself; they vote because the same Spirit who spoke through the apostles lives in the Church across every generation, and in him the living and the dead are one body.

The teaching content. Make first the distinction that the whole lecture turns on, and write it on the board: Tradition with a capital letter, and traditions with a small one. Tradition is the living handing-on, the *traditio*, the *paradosis*, of the whole Gospel: the faith handed from the apostles, lived, prayed, suffered, and transmitted within the Church under the Holy Spirit. Traditions, in the plural, are the customs, disciplines, and devotions that have grown up around the faith, and that the Church may keep, change, or set aside: a form of dress, a rule of fasting, a popular novena, a style of music, the language of a rite. The student who confuses the two will make one of two errors. He will either defend a passing custom as though the faith itself depended on it, or he will throw out the faith along with a custom he happens to dislike. The Church reveres Tradition, and she reforms traditions. The two acts are not in conflict; they are the marks of a living body.

Tradition is not a second stack of facts laid beside the Bible. That is the old caricature, and Lecture 16 will show how the Council moved past it. Tradition is rather the living stream within which the Scriptures are carried, read, prayed, and understood. It includes the creeds, the liturgy, the witness of the Fathers, the lives of the saints, the faith of the worshipping community across the centuries: the whole living memory of the Church. It is less like a second book and more like the living voice and life of the family within which the family book is read.

Give the students the saying they should keep for life, from Jaroslav Pelikan: "Tradition is the living faith of the dead; traditionalism is the dead faith of the living" (*The Vindication of Tradition*). Unpack it slowly. Tradition is alive: it is the faith of those who have gone before us, still living in the communion of saints, still handed to us warm. Traditionalism is its corpse: the clinging to the outward forms of the past with no living faith inside them, the museum-keeping of customs whose meaning has been forgotten. The Church wants the

first and not the second. To revere Tradition is the opposite of traditionalism, just as to honour a living grandmother is the opposite of keeping a dead one embalmed in the front room.

Now answer the title directly, with the help of the writer who gave us the phrase behind it. G. K. Chesterton called Tradition "the democracy of the dead," the refusal to let our ancestors be silenced merely because they happen not to be walking about; tradition, he said, gives a vote to the most obscure of all classes, our forefathers (*Orthodoxy*, chapter 4). The opposite of this is what C. S. Lewis named chronological snobbery, the assumption that whatever is newest is therefore truest, and whatever is old is therefore outworn. The dead get a vote because they are not gone; in Christ they are alive, and the Church is their communion across time. To ignore the Fathers, the martyrs, the saints, and the councils because they are old is not progress but a kind of orphaning, the cutting of the living branch from its own root.

Show, finally, how Tradition can be both living and faithful at once: it develops without changing its identity. *Dei Verbum* 8 teaches that the apostolic Tradition makes progress in the Church under the Holy Spirit, that there is a growth in the understanding of the realities and the words that have been handed on, as the Church across the centuries moves toward the fullness of divine truth. The faith does not change; our grasp of it deepens. John Henry Newman gave the picture the students should keep: the great oak grows from the small acorn, and the oak is not a different thing from the acorn but its faithful unfolding (*An Essay on the Development of Christian Doctrine*). A doctrine develops the way a child grows into an adult, the same person throughout, and not the way one animal turns into another. The test of true development is that it preserves the identity of the faith; a so-called development that contradicts what went before is not growth but corruption, which returns us to the line of Lecture 10.

Close with the two truths that gather the lecture. The one apostolic Tradition is carried in many living traditions: the Latin and the Byzantine, and on the soil of India the Syro-Malabar and the Syro-Malankara, each an ancient way of handing on the one faith. Variety in the traditions is not a wound in the Tradition. And the deepest answer to the title is the communion of saints. The dead in Christ are not absent but alive in him; the Church is one body across the generations, held together not by mere human memory but by the Holy Spirit, who is the living memory of the Church. Jesus promised that the Spirit would teach the disciples all things and bring to their remembrance all that he had said (John 14:26), and would guide the Church into all the truth (John 16:13). Tradition is the Spirit keeping the Church faithful to her Lord across time. That is why the voice of the dead still counts: it is, in the end, the voice of the Spirit who does not die.

Illustration. The first image is the relay and the baton. A relay race is run by many runners across a long course, and the one thing that must pass unbroken from hand to hand is the baton. No runner made the baton; each receives it from the one before and hands it on to the one after; and the whole race is lost if a single runner drops it, or, worse, swaps it for a different baton of his own making. The faith is that race, run across the centuries; the baton is the one Gospel; *tradere* is to hand it on. The runner who imagines he can run a better race

with a baton he invented himself has not improved the race. He has left it. The dead are the runners who carried the baton safely to our hands; we run our own lap, and we hand it on.

The second image is the seed kept for sowing. A wise farmer never eats all his grain; he keeps back the best of every harvest as *bija*, the seed for next year, and hands it down so that the field may bear again and again. The seed is one with every harvest, the same wheat year after year, and yet each year it grows in new soil under new rain. Tradition is the seed-grain of the faith, kept and sown by each generation. The family that eats its seed has a full belly for one winter and a dead field forever; the family that guards and sows it keeps the harvest alive for the children of its children. And the seed, once sown, does not become a different plant; the wheat comes up wheat, which is the very unfolding of identity that Newman saw in the acorn and the oak.

References. *Dei Verbum*, Chapter 2, sections 7 to 10, for the handing on of revelation, and *Dei Verbum* 8 in particular, for the development of the understanding of the faith under the Holy Spirit. Jaroslav Pelikan, *The Vindication of Tradition* (New Haven: Yale University Press, 1984), for Tradition as the living faith of the dead. G. K. Chesterton, *Orthodoxy* (1908), chapter 4, for Tradition as the democracy of the dead. John Henry Newman, *An Essay on the Development of Christian Doctrine* (1845), for the acorn and the oak and for the preservation of identity in true development. John 14:26 and John 16:13, in the Revised Standard Version, Catholic Edition, for the Holy Spirit as the memory and the guide of the Church. The Manual, pages 3 to 4, for Tradition among the sources. Catechism of the Catholic Church 74 to 83, for the transmission of divine revelation and the one deposit of faith.

Cross-references. Tradition is the partner of Scripture from Lecture 12, and the two are bound into one wellspring at Lecture 16. The line between true development and corruption reaches back to the marks and the heresy of Lecture 10. The whole of Unit IV, the history of theology, is the unfolding of this one Tradition across the ages, so that this lecture is the doorway to Lectures 17 to 22, where the second precept, be intelligent, will ask what question each age was answering. The love of the Fathers and the living memory of the Church return in Lecture 29, on Orthodox theology, which prizes the patristic witness above all. The precept be attentive asks the theologian to attend not only to the printed page but to the living voice of the Church across time.

For the professor. You will have in the room two kinds of student, and this lecture is medicine for both. The one who loves the old customs must learn that not every old thing is Tradition, and that to defend a passing discipline as though it were the faith is to misplace his loyalty. The one who loves the new must learn that the new is not therefore true, and that to despise the Fathers because they are old is chronological snobbery and a kind of orphaning. Bring both to the communion of saints, which is the warm heart of the lecture, and end there, with the thought that when we pray the Creed we pray it together with the dead who are alive in Christ. Reading: *Dei Verbum*, Chapter 2, sections 7 to 10; the Manual, pages 3 to 4. Reflection prompt: "One thing handed on to me by Christians now dead, without which my faith would be poorer, is..."

LECTURE 14: Who decides when we disagree?

The opening problem. Sooner or later two good Catholics, or a learned theologian and a bishop, will read the same Scripture and the same Tradition and reach opposite conclusions. Then the hard question stands up in the room: who decides? Without someone to decide, the Church scatters into ten thousand private opinions, which is the very fracturing that Lecture 12 saw inside the slogan "the Bible alone." But with someone to decide, the anxious student fears that freedom of thought dies and the theologian is reduced to a parrot. Hold both halves of the tension honestly, for both are real: a Church needs a voice that can settle the matter, and a theologian needs the honest freedom to think. The answer is the teaching office of the Church, the Magisterium, understood rightly: not as the master of the Word but as its servant, and not as a power floating above the faithful but as the head listening to the whole body.

The teaching content. Say first what the Magisterium is. The word comes from *magister*, teacher. The Magisterium is the living teaching office of the Church, entrusted to the Pope and to the bishops in communion with him, whose task is to guard and to interpret authentically the Word of God, written in Scripture and handed on in Tradition. Now write on the board the sentence that orders the whole lecture, from *Dei Verbum* 10: the teaching office is not above the Word of God but serves it, teaching only what has been handed on, listening to it devoutly, guarding it reverently, and explaining it faithfully. The Magisterium is servant, not master, of the Word. The Pope cannot wake one morning and add a new article to the Creed; he is bound to hand on what he himself has received. This single sentence cures the student who imagines the Church may teach whatever the Pope happens to please.

The teaching office speaks in two manners, and the student must learn to tell them apart. The extraordinary Magisterium is the solemn definition, exercised by an ecumenical council, or by the Pope defining a matter of faith from the chair, *ex cathedra*, as at Nicaea, or in the definitions of the Immaculate Conception and the Assumption. The ordinary Magisterium is the constant daily teaching of the Pope and the bishops, in encyclicals, in catechesis, in the steady preaching of the faith; and when the bishops dispersed throughout the world agree in holding one teaching to be definitive, this is the universal ordinary Magisterium, which also binds. These manners differ in weight, and so the assent owed to them differs: the assent of faith for what is solemnly defined as revealed, and a religious submission of mind and will for the authoritative but not definitive teaching of the Church (Lumen Gentium 25; Donum Veritatis 23). Teach the students plainly that not every sentence a churchman utters carries the same authority, and that learning to weigh these grades is part of becoming a responsible theologian.

Now the *sensus fidelium*, lest the student picture the teaching office as a tower floating high above the people. Lumen Gentium 12 teaches that the whole body of the faithful, anointed by the Holy One, cannot err in matters of belief, and that this supernatural sense of the faith, the *sensus fidei*, is shown when the whole people of God, from the bishops to the last of the faithful, manifests a universal agreement in matters of faith and morals. So the faith

of the whole Church is itself a true source, which the teaching office listens to and consults. The faithful who believe, the theologians who think, and the bishops who teach are not three rival powers but one living body, discerning the faith together, each with its own gift (International Theological Commission, *Sensus Fidei in the Life of the Church*, 2014). This is already the seed of synodality, which Lecture 31 will name: the whole Church listening, the apostolate of the ear.

Then face the hard case, and face it more honestly than the old manuals did. What happens when a theologian and the teaching office disagree? *Donum Veritatis* takes it up squarely (sections 13 to 21). The theologian owes the Magisterium a religious submission, and he does not set up a rival teaching authority of his own; and yet he may raise honest questions, and even difficulties, through the proper channels and in the right spirit, and his patient, searching work often serves the Church by helping the faith to be understood afresh. The bond between the theologian and the teaching office is a real tension, sometimes a painful one, and it is not healed by rupture on either side. Give the students living faces. Edward Schillebeeckx was investigated more than once by the Congregation for the Doctrine of the Faith, and yet he continued his work and died within the communion of the Church: the very picture of the tension carried, and not broken. Yves Congar and Henri de Lubac were silenced or restricted in the years before the Council, and were then vindicated as among the chief architects of the Second Vatican Council itself: the picture of the patient theologian whose hour finally came. These men show what it costs, and what it means, to hold fidelity and honesty together, and they prepare the great question of Lecture 34, obedience or prophecy.

End by holding the tension open, not by collapsing it. The student tempted toward an easy authoritarianism, who would settle every question by simply citing the latest Roman document, must hear "servant, not master," and must learn that the teaching office is itself bound to the Word and to the living faith of the whole Church. The student tempted toward an easy dissent, who would make his private opinion a second magisterium and carry his quarrel to the newspapers, must learn the discipline of the loyal son, who speaks his mind at the family table and does not walk out to found a rival family down the road. Authority and freedom are not enemies here; rightly ordered, each one serves the truth. The teaching office exists not to crush thought but to keep the one faith one, so that the theologian has a faith worth thinking about.

Illustration. You gave the students the orchestra on Day One, in the architecture of the course, and it serves here too in a single sentence: the conductor who does not write the music, but keeps the players faithful to the score, is the teaching office. Recall it, and then give them a fresh image for this lecture.

The first fresh image is the judge who serves the law. A judge does not write the law; the makers of the law do that. The judge receives the law, reads it, and, when two parties come before him in genuine dispute, settles the case by the law and not by his own taste. A judge who invented law to suit his mood, or who decided cases by whim, would betray the bench, for his whole authority is to serve a law he did not make. The teaching office is the judge who serves the Word of God: it does not compose the Gospel; it guards and applies it, and it

settles the case when the faithful are truly divided. And as a courtroom needs a judge, not because the parties are wicked but because without one every dispute becomes a brawl, so the Church needs a teaching office, not because the faithful are faithless but because a family of more than a billion people, all reading one Word, needs a voice that can say, at last, "this is what we hold."

The second image is the loyal son at the table. Picture a grown son who loves his father, and who nonetheless, at the family table, disagrees with him about a grave matter. The loyal son speaks his mind plainly and with respect; he does not swallow his honest thought, for that would be a lie; and yet neither does he overturn the table, storm out, and start a rival family down the road. He says his piece, he stays, and he trusts that around the one table, in time, the truth will out. Schillebeeckx and Congar were such sons. The disloyal son is the one who makes his disagreement the whole of his identity and leaves; the servile son is the one who has no honest thought at all. The responsible theologian is neither.

References. *Dei Verbum* 10, for the teaching office as the servant and not the master of the Word of God. *Lumen Gentium* 12, for the *sensus fidei* of the whole people of God, which cannot err in believing, and *Lumen Gentium* 25, for the grades of teaching and the assent owed to each. Congregation for the Doctrine of the Faith, *Donum Veritatis* (1990), sections 13 to 21, for the bond of the theologian and the teaching office and the right handling of difficulties, with sections 23 to 24 on the grades of assent. International Theological Commission, *Sensus Fidei in the Life of the Church* (2014), for the faith-sense of the whole Church. Catechism of the Catholic Church 85 to 87 and 92 to 93, for the teaching office and the supernatural sense of the faith. The cases of Edward Schillebeeckx, Yves Congar, and Henri de Lubac, for the tension between the theologian and the teaching office, carried in fidelity.

Cross-references. The teaching office serves the Scripture of Lecture 12 and the Tradition of Lecture 13, and the three together are bound at Lecture 16, in *Dei Verbum* 10, none of them standing without the others. The discernment of the line between faith and heresy, named in Lecture 10 as the work of the community and the teaching office, finds its agent here. The *sensus fidelium* and the whole Church listening together open toward synodality in Lecture 31, the apostolate of the ear. The hard case of the theologian and the teaching office returns directly in Lecture 34, where the course asks whether the responsible theologian must choose between obedience and prophecy, and it is held finally in the Manifesto of Lecture 35. The library hunt to find one real disagreement between Rahner and Ratzinger belongs near this lecture, for it shows two great and faithful theologians differing within the one communion. The precept be attentive governs even the teaching office, which is itself an act of the Church attending to the Word and to the faith of her people.

For the professor. Resist the urge to make this lecture easy by collapsing the tension to one side. If you make it all authority, you form parrots; if you make it all freedom, you form factions. The gift of the hour is the living example: a real man, Schillebeeckx, investigated and yet faithful unto death, shows the students that the tension can be carried by a whole human being and need not break him. Tell them plainly that they will one day feel this

tension in their own ministry, when a Roman document and their own honest reading seem to pull apart, and that the course is forming them to carry it as loyal sons and honest thinkers at once. Reading: *Lumen Gentium*, section 12; *Donum Veritatis*, sections 13 to 21. Reflection prompt: "When the teaching of the Church and my own thinking seem to disagree, the first thing I will do is..."

LECTURE 15: Can reason and experience be sources too?

The opening problem. We have named the three sources that the textbooks always name: Scripture, Tradition, and the teaching office. But is that the whole list? Can human reason be a source of theology? Can ordinary experience, the experience of a mother who has buried a child, of a labourer cheated of his wages, of the poor of this land, be a source, or are these only illustrations of truths already known from elsewhere? The bookish seminarian assumes that all theology lives in the library. This lecture makes a quieter and a harder claim: that the widow in the back pew may know something about God that the whole library has missed, and that to leave her out is to do theology with a missing source. Pose the question gently, and then open the door past the library, toward the parish and the slum.

The teaching content. Take reason first, briefly, for it has walked with us since Lecture 9 and Lecture 11. Faith and reason are the two wings on which the human spirit rises toward the truth. Reason is not a rival to revelation but a true light: by it, as the First Vatican Council taught and as Paul says, God can be known with certainty from the things he has made (Romans 1:20); and by it faith seeks to understand itself. Reason supplies the questions theology must answer, the tools it thinks with, and the tests that keep it honest. So reason is, at the very least, the indispensable co-worker of theology, and in a real sense a source, for it is reason that frames the very questions to which revelation is the answer.

Now experience, and here is the contemporary turn the students met in Lecture 8, the turn to the subject and to context. Lived experience is a true theological source, not because experience stands over revelation, but because revelation is received and read in and through experience. God speaks not only in the sacred text but in the events of life, in what the Council called the signs of the times, to be read in the light of the Gospel (*Gaudium et Spes* 4). The faith experience, as Lecture 6 said, is the starting point of all theologising. And among the many experiences that feed theology, one has a privileged voice already inside Scripture itself: the experience of the poor.

This is the cry of the poor, and the poor of God whom Scripture calls the *anawim*, the bowed-down ones, the widow, the orphan, the stranger, the landless, those whose cry God himself hears. At the burning bush the Lord says that he has seen the affliction of his people and has heard their cry, and that he knows their sufferings (Exodus 3:7). The Psalmist sings, "This poor man cried, and the Lord heard him" (Psalm 34:6). Mary sings that God has cast down the mighty and lifted up the lowly (Luke 1:52). And the Lord himself makes the least of his brothers and sisters the very place where he is met or missed, for what is done to the least is done to him (Matthew 25:40). The poor are not only the objects of our charity; they

are a place where God is known, a *locus theologicus*. This is what Lecture 26 will study as liberation and Dalit theology, and what the architecture of this course called the view from below, the worm view from the ground that sees what the bird high in the sky cannot. Gustavo Gutiérrez gave it a name the students should carry: theology as critical reflection on praxis in the light of the Word, where the praxis is the living-out of faith in solidarity with the poor (*A Theology of Liberation*). The cry of the poor is real data, not decoration; and to attend to it is the precept of this whole unit, be attentive, at its sharpest and most costly, for it asks the theologian to attend to the very ones whom no one else attends to.

The Indian sharpening must not be allowed to stay abstract. In India the *anawim* have faces and names. They are the Dalit, kept for centuries on the far side of a line; the Adivasi, the tribal peoples of the forests and the hills, many of them Santali here in Bengal; the landless labourer; the migrant who leaves home to lay bricks in a far city; the woman who is poor twice over, once for her poverty and once for her sex. The seminarian of Bengal will not serve God in a library; he will serve him among these. What does the widow know that the library can miss? She knows the weight of injustice from the inside, the nearness of God to the broken, the meaning of the cross felt and not merely studied. A theology that never sits at her feet is a theology with a closed window, however full its shelves.

Guard the balance with equal care, lest the student now swing to the opposite error and make his own feelings the measure of all things. Experience is a source under the Word, not over it. The marks of Lecture 10 still hold; the cry of the poor is read within Scripture, Tradition, and the discernment of the Church, and not against them. Experience cut loose from the Word can mislead, for every age is tempted to baptise its own prejudices and call them the voice of God. So the list of sources is not *sola experientia* any more than it is *sola scriptura*. Gather the whole into the four pillars on which the doing of theology rests, named in the architecture and returning in Lecture 23: Scripture, Tradition, faith experience, and the social context. This lecture completes the account of the sources by adding reason and experience to the three that the manuals name, and by setting them in their right order, under the Word and within the believing community.

Illustration. The first image is the well and the monsoon rain. Picture the sources of theology as a deep well and as the rain that falls on the field. Scripture, Tradition, and the teaching office are the deep well, the sure water of revelation, which does not run dry. Reason is the rope and the bucket by which we draw that water up, and the cup from which we drink it; without reason the well is full and we stay thirsty. And experience, above all the experience of the poor, is the monsoon rain that falls on the parched field and tells the farmer, better than any printed almanac, what the land is actually suffering and what it needs. A farmer who reads only the almanac, and never once feels the rain on his own skin and the cracked earth under his own feet, will sow at the wrong time and lose the crop. The theologian drinks from the well, draws with the rope of reason, and reads the rain of the life of the people upon the land.

The second image is the widow and her two coins. In the Gospel of Mark, Jesus sits opposite the temple treasury and watches the rich put in large sums; then a poor widow comes and puts in two small copper coins, all that she has. He calls his disciples to him and teaches

them from her, that she has given more than all the others, for they gave out of their abundance and she out of her poverty, her whole living (Mark 12:41 to 44). See what happens: the Lord draws his lesson not from the rich treasury but from the poor widow, and she becomes the teacher of the apostles. Here, in the pages of Scripture itself, the experience and the gift of the poor are a source from which the Lord himself teaches. The seminarian who learns to watch the widow as Jesus watched her will never again think that the poor have nothing to teach him about God.

References. John Paul II, *Fides et Ratio*, the opening and the sections that follow, for faith and reason as the two wings and for reason in the service of faith. The First Vatican Council, *Dei Filius*, with Romans 1:20, for the knowledge of God by the light of reason from created things. Gaudium et Spes 4, for the reading of the signs of the times in the light of the Gospel. Gustavo Gutiérrez, *A Theology of Liberation* (1971), chapter 1, for theology as critical reflection on praxis in the light of the Word and for the privileged place of the poor. For the poor of God and the *anawim*: Exodus 3:7, Psalm 34:6, Luke 1:46 to 55, and Matthew 25:31 to 46; and for the widow and her two coins, Mark 12:41 to 44; all in the Revised Standard Version, Catholic Edition. The Manual, pages 3 to 4, for reason, experience, and the cry of the poor among the sources. For the Indian sharpening, the Dalit theology of Lecture 26, drawn from A. P. Nirmal.

Cross-references. Reason and experience reach back to revelation in deeds and events in Lecture 3, to the faith experience as the starting point in Lecture 6, to the turn to context in Lecture 8, and to faith and reason as the two wings in Lectures 9 and 11. They reach forward into the heart of the course in Unit V: to the four pillars and the pastoral cycle of See, Judge, Act in Lecture 23; to the praxis model, liberation and Dalit theology, and the view from below in Lecture 26; to Indian theology and the triple dialogue with cultures, religions, and the poor in Lecture 27; and to the cry of the earth bound to the cry of the poor in Lecture 32. The precept be attentive reaches here its sharpest demand, the attending to the unattended.

For the professor. This is the lecture that opens the eyes of the seminarian past the library to the parish and the slum, so do not let it stay in the air; make it concrete with the poor of Bengal whom these men will actually serve, the Santali villager, the brick-kiln migrant, the woman doubly burdened. Then guard the balance with equal care, for the danger here runs both ways: the student who believes all theology lives in books, and the student who would make his own feelings the voice of God. Experience is a source under the Word, not a free pass. End on the widow and her two coins, and let the students sit a while with the fact that the Lord taught his own apostles from a poor woman. Reading: the Manual, pages 3 to 4; Gustavo Gutiérrez, *A Theology of Liberation*, the opening of chapter 1. Reflection prompt: "Something I have learned about God from a poor person, which no book taught me, is..."

LECTURE 16: How did Vatican II re-map the sources?

The opening problem. For centuries the seminary textbooks drew the sources of revelation as two separate pipes, Scripture and Tradition, two distinct quarries from which the Church

mined her truths, and some even spoke of truths contained in Tradition that are nowhere in Scripture at all, the so-called two-source theory, partly in Scripture and partly in Tradition. When the Second Vatican Council opened in 1962, the prepared text on the sources, titled *De Fontibus Revelationis*, On the Sources of Revelation, assumed exactly this old map and was written in the dry style of the manuals. What happened next is one of the most telling moments of the whole Council, and it is worth telling the students as the drama that it was, for it shows that even the map of the sources has a history. Pose it so: what was the old map, why did the Council refuse it, and what truer map did it draw in its place?

The teaching content. Picture the old map first: two separate streams from two separate tanks, Scripture in one and Tradition in the other, each delivering its own load of revealed truths, with the quiet suggestion that Tradition is a second deposit of facts standing apart from the Bible. The original conciliar text, *De Fontibus Revelationis*, took this picture for granted.

Now tell the drama plainly. In November of 1962 the fathers of the Council debated this prepared text, and a clear majority found it unworthy: too narrow, too defensive, too far from Scripture and from the Fathers. A vote was taken to set the schema aside; the majority in favour fell just short of the two-thirds then required to throw it out, and the debate threatened to stall. On the following day Pope John XXIII intervened and ordered the text withdrawn and rewritten by a new and mixed commission. From that long rewriting came, three years later, the Dogmatic Constitution on Divine Revelation, *Dei Verbum*, promulgated in 1965, one of the four great Constitutions of the Council. Let the students feel the weight of this: the Council looked hard at its own first draft on the sources, and sent it back, because the Church had come to see her sources more truly than the manual had seen them. Joseph Ratzinger, who was present at those days as a young adviser, has left a first-hand account of them (*Theological Highlights of Vatican II*).

Then give the new map of *Dei Verbum*. In place of two separate quarries, the Constitution sets one wellspring and two streams. There is one source, properly speaking: God, who reveals himself and gives himself. And there is one Gospel, handed on in two manners, Sacred Scripture and Sacred Tradition, which, in the words of the Constitution, flow from the same divine wellspring, come together in some fashion to form one thing, and move toward the same end (*Dei Verbum* 9). Scripture and Tradition are bound closely together and communicate one with the other; they are not two rival pipes but two streams from one spring, two ways of handing on the one Word of God. The old and unhelpful contest, "is this truth found in Scripture, or in Tradition," gives way to a truer picture: the one Word reaches us through Scripture, read within Tradition, under the one Spirit.

The re-mapping is not a dry rearranging of categories; its very centre is worship. *Dei Verbum* 21 teaches that the Church has always venerated the divine Scriptures as she venerates the Body of the Lord, and that she offers to the faithful the bread of life from the one table of the Word of God and the Body of Christ. Hold up that image of the one table, for it is the heart of the whole re-mapping: Scripture is not a textbook to be quarried but bread to be broken, set on the same table as the Eucharist. This is the liturgical mark of theology from Lecture 10 made visible. From the same chapter, the Council calls for the Scriptures to

be opened wide to all the faithful, in their own tongues (*Dei Verbum* 22), and names the study of the sacred page the very soul of sacred theology and its perpetual foundation (*Dei Verbum* 24).

Finally, the threefold cord made one, which gathers the whole unit. *Dei Verbum* 10 binds together everything these six lectures have taught: Sacred Tradition, Sacred Scripture, and the teaching office of the Church are so joined and connected that none of them can stand without the others, and all of them together, each in its own way, under the action of the one Holy Spirit, contribute effectively to the salvation of souls. Read that sentence aloud, and point back to the board: Scripture, the norm normed by none, from Lecture 12; Tradition, its living stream, from Lecture 13; the teaching office, its servant, and the faith-sense of the whole people, from Lecture 14; reason and experience and the cry of the poor, the co-workers under the Word, from Lecture 15. They are not three or six rival powers but one living body, breathing with one Spirit. That single sentence of *Dei Verbum* 10 is the map of the whole of Unit III.

Close by naming the fruit for the seminarian of Bengal. He inherits a Council that ended the old contest between Scripture and Tradition, that put the open Bible into the hands of his people in Bengali and Santali and Hindi, that set the Word and the Sacrament on one table, and that named the Word the soul of his theology. He is to be a man of the open Bible and the one table, reading the Scriptures on his knees within the living Tradition of the Church. That is the re-mapped country he is called to serve.

Illustration. The first image is the old map and the new survey. For centuries the early mapmakers drew the coastline of a far country from the reports of sailors who had never properly landed, and their map showed two separate gulfs where the land was poorly known, with strange blank spaces between them. Then careful surveyors walked the actual coast and found that the two supposed gulfs were in truth one bay, fed by one great river, and the blank spaces were filled in rightly. The new map did not invent a new country; it showed the one country as it really is. *Dei Verbum* is the new and truer survey of the one territory of revelation: where the old manual drew two separate sources with a gap between them, the Council walked the ground and showed one wellspring, two streams, one bay where the faithful come to drink. The land had not changed. The map had become true.

The second image is the one table. A family does not eat at two separate tables, one set with the bread of the Word and another, far across the room, set with the bread of the Eucharist, as though these were two unrelated meals. It eats at one table, where the Scriptures are broken open and the Body of the Lord is given, the one nourishment of the one family. Before the Council, the Bible had drifted, in the imagination of many of the faithful, into a separate room, the preserve of scholars and of suspicion; the Council carried it back and set it on the one table beside the Eucharist, where it had always belonged. The seminarian who learns to break the Word as he breaks the Bread, at the one table, has understood the re-mapping in his bones.

References. *Dei Verbum*, Chapter 6, sections 21 to 26, for Sacred Scripture in the life of the Church, the one table of the Word and the Body, the opening of the Scriptures to all the faithful, and Scripture as the soul of theology; and, from the same Constitution, *Dei Verbum*

9, for the one wellspring and the two streams of Scripture and Tradition, and *Dei Verbum* 10, for the three so joined that none stands without the others. Neil Ormerod, *Introducing Contemporary Theologies*, Chapter 4, pages 52 to 57, for the account of the Council and its re-mapping of revelation and of method. Joseph Ratzinger, *Theological Highlights of Vatican II* (New York: Paulist Press, 1966), for a first-hand account of the rejection of *De Fontibus Revelationis* and the intervention of Pope John XXIII in November 1962. Catechism of the Catholic Church 80 to 95, for Scripture, Tradition, and the teaching office as one deposit, served by one office under one Spirit.

Cross-references. This lecture gathers the whole of Unit III: Scripture from Lecture 12, Tradition from Lecture 13, the teaching office and the *sensus fidelium* from Lecture 14, and reason and experience from Lecture 15. The one table grounds the liturgical and the biblical marks of authentic theology from Lecture 10. The drama of the rejected schema is itself a vivid instance of the lesson of the next unit, that every age, even a council, must read the signs of its own time, and so it opens toward Unit IV and the second precept, be intelligent. The Word and worship at the one table reach forward to Orthodox theology in Lecture 29, theology on the knees. With this lecture the first precept, be attentive, completes its work: the student has learned to attend to all the sources, rightly ordered, and is ready to be handed on to the history.

For the professor. Tell the historical drama with relish, for nothing fixes the lesson like the fact that the Council looked at its own prepared text on the sources and threw it back. Run the in-class comparison activity here: take one passage, the Beatitudes of Matthew 5, and set beside it how the same one Word is handed on through the Catechism, through a conciliar text such as *Lumen Gentium*, and through a Father of the Church, so that the students see with their own eyes that Scripture, the teaching office, the conciliar Tradition, and the patristic witness are not four rival sources but four channels of the one stream. Then close the whole unit by reading *Dei Verbum* 10 aloud, slowly, and pointing to each source listed on the board. Reading: *Dei Verbum*, Chapter 6, sections 21 to 26; Ormerod, Chapter 4, pages 52 to 57. Reflection prompt: "Now that the Council has set the Word and the Bread on one table, one thing I want to change in how I read the Bible is..."

CLOSING THE UNIT, AND THE BRIDGE TO UNIT IV

By the end of Unit III the students should be able to say where theology gets its content and who may say what is true. They have learned that plurality is not error but the health of a living faith, one Lord spoken in many tongues; that Scripture is the soul of theology and the norm normed by none, a book of the Church rightly read within the Church; that Tradition is the living faith of the dead, kept alive by the Spirit and developing without ever changing its identity; that the teaching office is the servant and not the master of the Word, and that it listens to the faith-sense of the whole people; that reason and experience, and above all the cry of the poor, are true sources under the Word; and that the Second Vatican Council bound all of these into one, one wellspring, two streams, one table, one Spirit. Above all, they have begun to practise the first precept of Lonergan, be attentive: to attend to the text

as it stands, to the living memory of the Church, to the voice of the teaching office, to the consent of the faithful, to honest reason, and to the cry that rises from the poor of this land.

The natural next question is how this one faith, received from these sources, has unfolded across the centuries, and why every age has produced a theology of its own. That is the work of Unit IV, the history of theology, Lectures 17 to 22, where the second precept, be intelligent, begins to govern, for the student must now seek not the dates but the question that each age was struggling to answer. The Gospel does not change; the questions do. The next installment of these notes will cover Unit IV, in the same form.

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